

GUIDELINE NUMBER: GL-IV-VA-010
CATEGORY: IV Therapy-
Vascular Access
DATE: February, 2025
NEXT REVIEW DATE: February, 2026

TITLE: Adult Peripherally Administered Vasopressor Protocol

PURPOSE: Guide medical staff in administering a single vasopressor through a peripheral IV for limited time

APPLICABILITY/CRITERIA FOR USE:

- Vasopressor agents may be administered through a peripherally inserted intravenous (PIV) catheter if the following criteria are met:
 - PIV is located in an upper extremity
 - PIV must be proximal to wrist
 - Contralateral to blood pressure cuff
 - PIV must have blood return prior to administration of vasopressor agent
 - Sized 20g PIV or larger
 - Must have additional PIV in place that may be used as a back up if the PIV infusing vasopressors fails
 - PIV dedicated to vasopressor
- Vasopressor infusing via PIV must have a standard concentration
 - Norepinephrine: 16 mcg/ml
 - Epinephrine: 16 mcg/ml
 - Phenylephrine: 100 mcg/ml
 - Vasopressin: 0.4 u/ml
- Dose and Duration
 - Maximum duration of 48 hours
 - Maximum dose of norepinephrine: 0.2 mcg/kg/min
 - Maximum dose of epinephrine: 0.2 mcg/kg/min
 - Maximum dose of vasopressin: 0.04 units/min
 - Maximum dose of phenylephrine: 2.0 mcg/kg/min

EXCLUSION CRITERIA:

- Excluded sites: External jugular, any lower extremity IV, midline intravenous lines

SPECIAL INSTRUCTIONS:

I. Monitoring and Reporting

- A. Upper extremity neurovascular check every 2 hours for the duration a vasopressor is being administered through a PIV
- B. Infiltration Protocol
 - 1. Rotate site (arm) to continue infusing vasopressors after an infiltration
 - 2. Refer to Policy Number 18-3: IV Infiltration and Extravasation Management
 - 3. Refer to Guideline GL-IV-VA-002: Peripheral Venous Access Care & Maintenance (PIV, Ultrasound Guided PIV, Midline Catheter)
 - a. Submit Patient Safety Report

DOCUMENTATION

- A. Document upper extremity neurovascular check every 2 hours for the duration a vasopressor is being administered through a PIV
- B. Document IV site assessment per GL-IV-VA-002 [https://bridge.ufhealth.org/policies/wp-content/uploads/sites/17/2020/06/Revised-FINAL-GL-IV-VA-002-PIV-ML-6.10.20 .pdf](https://bridge.ufhealth.org/policies/wp-content/uploads/sites/17/2020/06/Revised-FINAL-GL-IV-VA-002-PIV-ML-6.10.20.pdf)

KEYWORDS: PIV, peripheral, vasopressor

ASSOCIATED POLICIES:

- IV Infiltration and Extravasation Management Policy Number: 18-13
- Peripheral Venous Access Care & Maintenance (PIV, Ultrasound Guided PIV, Midline Catheter): GL-IV-VA-002
- Medication Administration Policy: MA-005

SIGNATURES:

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Associate VP of Nursing & Patient Services